🍲 Meal 9 – Traditional Couscous Tagine

🌍 North African-Inspired | Hearty | Aromatic

📋 MENU (for 35 people)

Main: Steamed couscous with a rich vegetable and chickpea stew (tagine-style)

Side: Fresh herb garnish and optional lemon wedges

⏱️ TOTAL PREP TIME: 1h 45

Team size: 4–5 people

Cooking Method: Stew in big pots, couscous steamed or soaked

Tools: Large pots, knives, cutting boards, mixing bowls, ladles, trays

🛒 INGREDIENT LIST (35 servings)

🥘 Tagine Stew

- • Chickpeas (cooked): 2.5 kg (or ~850 g dry = 2.5 kg cooked)
- • Onions (sliced): 1.5 kg
- • Carrots (chopped): 2 kg
- • Zucchini (chopped): 1.5 kg
- • Pumpkin or sweet potato (cubed): 2 kg
- • Tomatoes (chopped): 1 kg
- • Olive oil: 300 ml
- • Salt: 2 tbsp
- • Garlic (minced): 8 cloves
- • Ground cumin: 2 tbsp
- • Ground coriander: 2 tbsp
- • Paprika: 2 tbsp
- • Cinnamon (optional): 1 tsp
- • Fresh parsley and coriander: 2 bunches total
- • Water or veg broth: ~4 liters

🍚 Couscous

- • Couscous: 2.5 kg
- • Boiled water: ~3.5 liters
- • Salt: 1 tbsp
- • Olive oil: 100 ml

👨‍🍳 TEAM TASKS BREAKDOWN

Group 1 – Tagine Stew Prep

- • Chop onions, carrots, zucchini, pumpkin, tomatoes
- • Sauté onions and garlic in olive oil, add spices
- • Add all vegetables, chickpeas, and broth to pot
- • Simmer covered ~40–50 min until veg is soft and fragrant
- • Adjust salt and spice, stir in herbs last

Group 2 – Couscous Prep

- • Measure couscous into a large bowl
- • Pour in boiling water + salt + olive oil
- • Cover tightly and steam for 10–15 min
- • Fluff with fork, repeat steam if needed
- • Keep warm for serving

🕒 SUGGESTED TIME PLAN (1h 45 total)

00:00–00:15 — Divide into teams, gather tools and ingredients

00:15–00:40 — Chop vegetables, measure spices

00:40–00:50 — Start sautéing onions + garlic

00:50–01:20 — Cook stew on medium heat

01:00–01:20 — Soak and fluff couscous

01:20–01:40 — Final stew adjustments, herbs in

01:40–01:45 — Buffet setup, plate and serve

✅ NOTES

- • Add water gradually to stew if too thick — keep it rich but not dry.
- • Fluff couscous well to avoid clumping.
- • This dish holds well and gets better with 10 min rest before serving.